MGM HEALTHCARE

MGM Healthcare's Department of Neurology is dedicated to providing comprehensive medical care, and offers a wide array of treatments. The Department's expertise extends to the treatment of diverse neurological conditions, including but not limited to all types of headaches including refractory migraine, strokes, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, neuromuscular conditions, sleep disorders, and multiple sclerosis (and other autoimmune neurological diseases)

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Headaches especially migraines are ubiquitous ailments, with one in eight human beings in the world said to suffer from them. There are reportedly more than 1 billion people suffering from migraine globally. Yet, they are often misunderstood and sometimes confused with conditions like sinusitis and refractive errors of the eyes. Dr U. Meenakshisundaram, a distinguished neurologist with over 30 years of experience in his field, says, "The commonest cause of headache is migraine. It is often underdiagnosed and not properly treated." Incidentally, the prevalence is higher in women, with about 18-25% being affected, while only 10-15% men suffer from migraines with peak occurrence in the 3rd decade of life.

Vertigo is a very common encounter in neurological practice. Dr. U. Meenakshisundaram further explains: "Often lightheadedness or a floating feeling are mistaken for vertigo. For the condition to be classified as vertigo, there has to be a sense of rotation or loss of balance of self or the environment."

Dr U. Meenakshisundaram's expertise encompasses an array of neurological domains. He is a specialist in movement disorders, stroke, epilepsy, headache, spasticity, and neuromuscular conditions. He is also a leading expert in the use of botulinum toxin therapy for a range of neurological problems, including migraine.

THE IMPORTANCE OF TIMELY INTERVENTION

The importance of getting these issues treated promptly cannot be overemphasized. If diagnosed in time, the conditions can be managed with oral medication. While symptomatic drugs are used during acute attacks, some drugs are given as a prophylaxis if the issue is recurrent. Patients who have migraines several times a month cannot rely on painkillers alone and need to be on scientifically chosen drugs based on various other comorbidities or body habitua. This is especially critical in cases of migraine with aura, as they have been linked with a future risk of stroke.

Dr. U. Meenakshisundaram explains: "Migraine has many symptoms, ranging from a headache to difficulty in seeing light (photo phobia) or hearing sounds (phonophobia), numbness on one side, auras, and so on. Patients with complicated migraines develop weakness, numbness, difficulty in speaking before or during the headache and need to be treated on priority."

At MGM Healthcare's Department of Neurology, these conditions are treated mainly through oral medicines, but the Department also resorts to injectables and nasal sprays mainly in acute attacks. "Some patients suffering from refractory migraines do not respond to preventive medicines—for them we use nerve blocks as well as botulinum toxin which is an approved treatment all over the world," says Dr. U. Meenakshisundaram. While MGM Healthcare has the latest diagnostic equipment at its disposal, Dr. U. Meenakshisundaram emphasizes that "the most important tool for diagnosis is the patient's history, the extra two minutes spent with the patient being worth its weight in gold."

TREATING A HOST OF NEUROLOGICAL ISSUES

MGM Healthcare's Department of Neurology is equipped to handle all neurological concerns, be they acute or chronic. These include Alzheimer's disease, Parkinson's, multiple sclerosis, epilepsy, stroke, amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS), migraine, encephalitis and so on. The Department specializes in the treatment of Parkinson's disease using procedures like Deep Brain Stimulation (DBS). Its neurology team is trained in handling of movement disorders, including Parkinson's. "We also have an acute stroke care team with an intervention person available 24/7," says Dr. U. Meenakshisundaram. The Department also has the support of other departments when patients come in with issues like strokes where cardiac conditions or renal problems may coexist and also offers its own expertise in conditions involving other major organs, where neurological management is warranted.

The Department offers some of the most cutting-edge treatments currently available for neurological problems. For instance, for headaches, nerve blocks and botox therapy are offered as required. Epilepsy treatments include epilepsy surgery and long-term monitoring. "For strokes, we use interventions like thrombectomy and thrombolysis. For established strokes, we have neuro-rehabilitation including botulinum toxin therapy," explains Dr. U. Meenakshisundaram. Botox therapy is extensively used for movement disorders. Apart from that, there are facilities such as bedside EEG monitoring, critical care, and treatment of autoimmune conditions. MGM Healthcare's Department of Neurology is truly a one-stop for addressing all your neurological concerns.